

Jon Freshwater

jon.freshwater@gmail.com | San Francisco Bay Area | [linkedin.com/in/jon-freshwater](https://www.linkedin.com/in/jon-freshwater)

Brand and client leader with 20 years building brands, and the teams behind them, for Nike, Google, IBM, CoreWeave, and Tiger Woods' Sun Day Red. I pair brand strategy and creative leadership with hands-on AI fluency: I build the AI tools my teams run on, from automated SOW pipelines to a full-stack AI coaching app. Track record of turning ambiguous briefs into brand systems that ship and grow revenue, including a portfolio grown from \$1.5M to \$6.75M in one year and a brand launch that beat its first-month sales target on day one.

Brand Strategy | Brand Identity & Systems | Creative Leadership | Integrated Marketing
AI Workflow Design | Creative Operations | Budget & P&L Management | Executive Stakeholder Management

Professional Experience

Studio.One

PARTNER

2025 – Present

Partner leading client services and new business at a digital creative and development studio. Clients include [Lionsgate](#), [PagerDuty](#), [Freshworks](#), [Planetary Guardians \(Virgin\)](#), and [Coral Gardeners](#).

New Business & Client Leadership:

- Secured \$1.5M in new business in under a year, leading pitches, scoping, and pricing; manage a \$1.1M portfolio across 10 engagements.

Brand Strategy, Identity & Campaigns:

- Lionsgate (MovieSphere+):** Defined brand strategy, positioning, tagline, and brand platform; validated mid- and lower-funnel messaging through quantitative testing.
- Coral Gardeners:** Ground-up rebrand: redefined mission, vision, values, and positioning; delivered the “Power to the Gardeners” platform, identity, brand guidelines, brand film concept and script, website (coralgardeners.org), and social content.
- PagerDuty:** Took a brand campaign from concept through production across video, out-of-home, and digital.
- Planetary Guardians (Virgin):** Created the Planetary Health Club, a satirical two-day pop-up at NYC Climate Week 2026 hosting the Planetary Guardians and Sir Richard Branson.

AI-Powered Agency Operations:

- Built a business intelligence dashboard giving leadership a single view of revenue performance and projections, P&L, cash flow, client satisfaction, and team status.
- Built Claude-powered SOW and estimate generators, cutting scoping from 4–6 hours to about 10 minutes.
- Built an AI site auditor that assesses websites across 12 categories, including accessibility, performance, user journeys, and content, cutting audits from 2–4 days to minutes.
- Designed a Claude-based creative review system that scores work against the client brief on six criteria and tracks feedback across review rounds.

AKQA San Francisco

DIRECTOR, CLIENT SERVICES (Exec Team)

2023 – 2025

Head of the Client Services department, responsible for a \$50M portfolio across 25+ accounts, and member of the San Francisco Executive Leadership Team. Worked with AI and tech-forward clients including [CoreWeave](#), [Replit](#), [IBM](#), and [D-Wave](#).

Brand Strategy, Identity & Campaigns:

Led teams defining brand strategy and creating new identities for B2C and B2B brands, capturing their visual and verbal systems within comprehensive online guideline platforms for CoreWeave, Culligan, SentinelOne, and Sun Day Red.

Developed each brand's tone of voice, personality, and messaging framework to ensure consistency across every channel. Most notably, launched Tiger Woods' Sun Day Red brand, surpassing its first-month sales target on launch day. Led CoreWeave's rebrand and AI-produced IPO campaign, including a Times Square takeover (493M impressions, 65M video views). Led a unified social program for iFIT and NordicTrack across four channels (848M impressions, 3.8M engagements, 246% TikTok audience growth).

Team Management & Development:

Led a 10-person core team and 50+ cross-functional contributors; hired and developed teams across Strategy, Production, Creative Direction, Design, and Copywriting.

CLIENT PARTNER

2021 – 2023

Led a multi-functional team of 30 people across account and PM, strategy, design, and technology. Partnered with senior clients at [IBM](#), [iFIT](#), [NordicTrack](#), [SentinelOne](#), [Culligan](#), and [Enphase](#).

- Managed an \$8M portfolio, partnering with C-suite clients to evolve brand strategy and channel mix, driving 350% YoY revenue growth at a 47% gross margin.
- Defined the GoFundMe repositioning, developing a messaging framework, campaign concept, and channel strategy that reframed the brand from transactional to transformational.

SENIOR CLIENT DIRECTOR

2017 – 2021

Oversaw creative delivery and cross-agency collaboration for [IBM](#), [World Food Program \(WFP\)](#), [Novo](#), and [The Weather Channel](#) with budgets of over \$6 million.

- Led [Museum of the Unseen](#), a German Design Award-winning interactive installation at IBM Watson's Munich headquarters. Partnered with local developers, delivered creative, oversaw production, and managed final launch.
- Partnered with the World Food Program and Kate Hudson to launch a campaign raising \$200K+ for hunger relief.
- Reimagined IBM Watson's global brand identity, developing guidelines adopted by 2,000+ designers worldwide.

CLIENT DIRECTOR

2014 – 2017

Drove large-scale brand activations, product launches, and integrated campaigns for [Nike](#), [Jordan Brand](#), and [Google](#).

- Led a four-year partnership with Nike and Jordan Brand, scaling annual revenue from \$1M to \$7M.
- Produced [The Last Shot](#), an interactive LED court for Jordan Brand's 30th anniversary featuring DJ Khaled, Chris Paul, and Russell Westbrook; won a Grand Clio and Gold at Cannes Lions, The One Show, LIA, and the Andys.

ACCOUNT SUPERVISOR

2011 – 2014

Delivered integrated campaigns for [Visa Prepaid](#) and [Visa Signature](#) spanning digital, print, and broadcast.

AKQA London

ACCOUNT EXECUTIVE – SENIOR ACCOUNT MANAGER

2006 – 2011

Partnered with Unilever, Xbox, Heineken, and VW on global campaigns and platform builds, including Heineken.com, a storytelling hub connecting 70+ markets.

Projects, Education & Skills

- **AI Strength-Coaching App:** Designed and built a personal AI coaching app (React, TypeScript, Supabase, Anthropic API, Whisper) that generates training blocks from logged performance history. Sole product owner; directed development end to end with Claude Code across 150+ shipped issues.

Education: Bachelor of Arts (First Class), Design Management, Surrey Institute of Art and Design (United Kingdom).

Skills: Claude & Claude Code, OpenAI API, Make.com, Airtable, Supabase, AI-assisted prototyping (React/TypeScript), Figma, Notion, Canva, Adobe CC, Google Workspace.

Award Highlights

